

(Don't Write
anything in this Area)

- (b) Discuss the impact of Feminist and Women liberation movements on Marriage and Family. (15 marks)

Feminist movements are those movements that work to realize gender equality and throw light upon the rights of women.

Impact on marriage

- (i) Feminist movements have led to change in marriage payments systems. There has been a decrease in exploitative systems like dowry.
- (ii) Feminist movements also led to change in type of marriage. Feminist movements discourage polygyny and encourage monogamy.
- (iii) They led to increase in the age of marriage of girls due to focus on education of girls.
- (iv) They also led to increase in the personal autonomy of women thus

decreasing the role of preferential marriages in the society.

Impact on family :

- (i) ~~Preference~~ Feminist movements led to increase in neo-local families as seen in contemporary society.
- (ii) They led to a change in division of labour with more focus on a gender neutral division of domestic work.
- (iii) They led to increasing role of paternalistic care in child rearing thus gathering importance to the role of the father.
- (iv) They led to increasing financial independence of women, thus, there is an increase in single-parent families.
- (v) They also led to women raising

voice against domestic abuse thus reducing the level of abuse in families.

Some anthropologists also point out ill effects of these movements like increase in divorces, rising instability of families and outsourcing of socialisation to schools.

However, feminist movements have helped hugely in bringing some amount of gender parity in marital and familial lives thus reducing the exploitation of women and giving voice to abused women thus empowering them.